



THE PRINCESS BRIDE

BITCOIN
JUNE 2014

THE BITCOIN AUCTION

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FROM SEIZURE TO SALE.

A gavel waits beside a stack of envelopes. Warm light falls across a locked box, a book and an auction sheet. Everything in the room suggests paperwork, custody and procedure, yet the asset being sold cannot be lifted onto the desk. HISTROVE gives the sale of digital money the weight of a traditional auction, using familiar objects to picture an unfamiliar government lot.

On 27 June 2014, the US Marshals Service held an online auction for approximately 29,656 BTC forfeited from wallet files on Silk Road's servers. The sale followed the marketplace's shutdown in 2013. It covered this specific group of bitcoins, rather than every coin seized in the wider investigation; the separate, much larger holding seized from Ross Ulbricht was excluded from the June sale.

Registered participants submitted bids electronically during a twelve-hour window. The sealed-bid process asked them to state their offers without an open room of rivals calling out prices. The bitcoins were divided into ten lots, and venture capitalist Tim Draper was subsequently identified as the buyer of the entire offering. The physical envelopes and gavel in the illustration give that process a shape, but do not reconstruct its actual operation.

The contrast is what makes the moment memorable. Money associated with a hidden online market was passing through a public institution's formal disposal process. The asset remained digital; the authority controlling its next transfer had changed. HISTROVE leaves the buyer outside the frame and keeps attention on the handover itself. The Princess Bride volume quietly leads back to Silk Road's earlier chapter, while the dated sheet brings the story forward to the sale.

DETAILS IN THE ART

01 THE PRINCESS BRIDE

The navy book returns from 016, Silk Road Shutdown. It connects the chapters visually, without claiming this copy appeared at the auction. Its placement is an intentional collection callback.

02 THE EVIDENCE CORD

Red cord and a blank tag sit with the locked box. They symbolise an asset moving from seizure into formal disposal. The locked box represents custody of a digital asset.

03 ENVELOPES AND A GAVEL

These familiar auction objects stand for formal bidding. The June sale was conducted online with sealed bids; the room and its desk are an illustrative interpretation, not a documentary reconstruction.

04 THE DATED SHEET

BITCOIN and JUNE 2014 identify the subject and month of the sale. The sheet is a fictional administrative prop, rather than a reproduction of an official lot listing.

SOURCE & ART NOTE

The FBI's [retrospective](#) records the June sale and amount; [ABC News](#) documents its date and scope. [Contemporary Reuters reporting](#) identifies the online sealed-bid format and buyer, while a [contemporary bidder statement filed with the SEC](#) records ten lots. The official's identity, room, envelopes, gavel and placement of the callback book are imagined. FROM SEIZURE TO SALE is editorial copy; no physical coin hoard or live auction-room scene is claimed.